

DAY AT THE MUSEUM

Level 2-4
20 min - 1 hour

A Personal Museum of What Matters

Wellness Domains

Intellectual

Topic:

Expression and personal meaning.

Goals:

Participant can reflect, make choices, and express personal meaning with minimal support.

Materials (Included/Subs):

- Paper or poster board
- Pen or marker
- Optional: tablet/phone for image searching
- Optional: printed images, magazines, small objects, frame, pedestal (paper option included)
- Optional: Explanation card(s)

Background:

Have you been to a museum lately? Let's explore a few things before diving into the activity. Everything in the museum is there for a reason. The *curator plans and chooses what belongs, where it should go and why. They use the objects to tell a story. The helper's role is to listen, clarify, and support expression.*

Examples:

- Sports
- My family traditions
- Quilting, crafts
- Favorite book, TV show, movie
- My favorite things
- Travels
- Modes of transportation

Structure / Activity:

In this activity, the participant becomes a museum curator. They will design a fictional museum exhibit based on something they care about, value, or strongly prefer. The exhibit can reflect personal taste, beliefs, interests, or life perspective. The participant selects up to 10 items for the exhibit. Items may be imagined, drawn, written, printed from the internet, or represented with objects on hand.

Steps:

- Introduce the role and activity. Explain "You are the curator of a museum exhibit. This exhibit shows something you care about."
- Choose the exhibit theme. Some potential prompts:
 - Family
 - Places I've been
 - A favorite hobby or person
- Select exhibit items. Invite the participant to choose up to 10 items that belong in their exhibit. Items can be real, symbolic, drawn or imagined.
- Organize the exhibit. Ask them to arrange or list the items in any order that feels right.
- Name the exhibit. Invite them to give the exhibit a title.
- Share the meaning, ask the participant to explain:
 - Why they chose the theme
 - What the items matter
- Closing: Take a photo of the exhibit or write a short exhibit description together.

Adaptations & Safety Precautions:

- Avoid debating or challenging values
- If strong emotions arise, slow the pace
- The participant controls what they share
- Offer to do this in 2 parts, determine the theme and order.
- Encourage deeper reflection or comparison between items
- Invite them to imagine an audience for the exhibit



